



## Tweaking VirtualDub's Performance

Performance is key when you're talking about encoding large files, and this can take hours depending on the size of the video and the codecs used. VirtualDub allows you to make some small changes that can help boost performance.

Select **Options > Performance**. The sliders here can be used to change the amount of buffer for WAV and AVI output. Changing the buffer for AVI can help speed up performance while working with very large uncompressed files, although it must be said that making any drastic changes can cause major instability.

The other useful feature appears when the encoding process is on. You can use the drop-down from the processing window and change the processing thread priority. If you always want encoding to be set as high priority, select **Options > Preferences**. Under **Dub defaults** in the **General** section, set the process priority to the level you want. Setting it to **Idle** will allow you to work on other programs without VirtualDub taking up all the CPU. Setting it to **Higher** or **Even Higher** will not allow other programs to make use of the CPU, but performance can go up a little.



## Combining Multiple AVIs

Home videos are most often multiple, small clips which we would like joined together as one contiguous video. VirtualDub allows you to add and then encode them as a single file. Just make sure the videos are AVIs.

First select **File > Open video file**. Choose the first video clip and click **Open**. Use the slider and move it to the absolute end of the video. Now select **File > Append AVI Segment** and choose the file you want to add to the end of the file. Follow the same steps for the rest of the clips before finally entering your encoder settings, then save the file.



## Cutting Up Clips

You might want to know how to split videos and cut out unnecessary sections. Open the video that needs to be cut. Move the slider to the position of the start of the cut, and press the **[Home]** key or select **Edit > Set selection start**. Now move the slider to the end of the cut and click **[End]** (or select **Edit > Set selection end**). This creates a selection. Pressing **[Delete]** or selecting **Edit > Delete** will cut out the selection. You can also do other tasks like copying and pasting of selections in the same manner using the **Edit** menu.

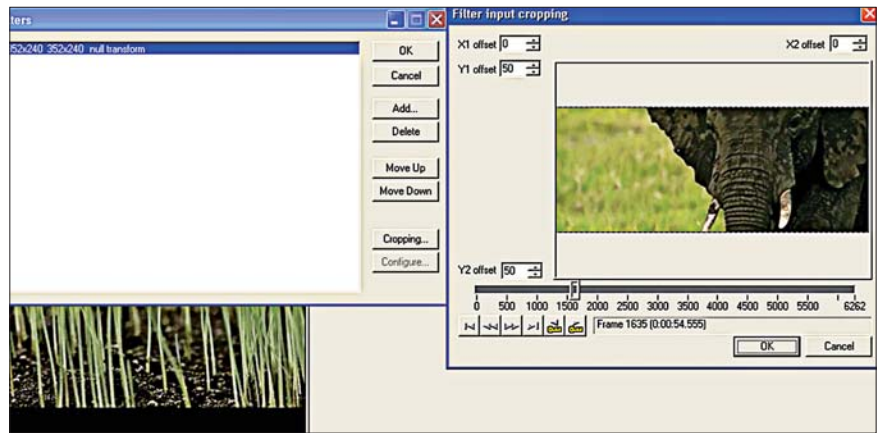
If you want to quickly be able to select certain portions and output them

to files, it can be done by creating selections using the steps we just mentioned. Now directly jump to setting up compression levels and codec settings, which can be accessed from the **Audio** and **Video** menus. Select **File > Save as AVI**. Only the selection will be exported.



## Cropping Videos

Videos, depending on the source and aspect ratio, have black bands at the top and bottom. Unnecessary information such as logos and headers may be displayed in those areas, or the section might not be needed at all. You can crop out those areas using the **Cropping** feature. Open your video and select **Video > Filter**. Click **Add**,



The video cropping feature allows you to crop out unnecessary areas on-screen

choose **Null Transform**, and click **OK**. The **Null Transform** filter is a filter that is meant to be used for changes like cropping, and serves no purpose other than that. Now click the **Cropping** button. Change the values of the **Y** offsets to crop the video vertically. (You can also crop the video horizontally using the **X** offsets if needed.)



## Fixing Audio Sync Problems

Some videos have audio sync problems; you have a person saying something on-screen with his voice lagging a second or two behind the video. It can be the other way round as well.

To fix this, you need to compensate by shifting the audio a little behind or forward in time. Select **Audio > Interleaving**. Under **Audio** correction, you can enter a suitable value in ms. Add a positive value to have the video lagging and a negative value for the audio to lag. You will require some trial and error runs to get it spot on.



## Changing Video Frame Rates

VirtualDub can change frame rates of video in order to fix audio sync or just to bring down file sizes. Be well

aware that changing frame rates can create issues with already well-synced videos. Video frame rates can be changed by pressing **[Ctrl] + [R]** or selecting **Video > Frame Rate**. Click the radio button for **Change to** (text entry box) frames per second and enter a suitable value.



## Capturing Video

VirtualDub can be used to dump video streams using your TV-Tuner card to your hard disk. This is useful for recording video clips from your camera, for example, or TV channels. To start capturing, select **File > Capture AVI**. A different window will take the place of the usual VirtualDub interface. You need to first select a

device: select the **Device** menu and choose from one of the devices. Then select a file where the video should be dumped. Select **File > Set capture file**, and set a file and location.

To start the capturing, you can click on **Capture > Capture Video**, or use the shortcuts **[F5]** or **[F6]**. To stop capturing, press **[Esc]**. Codecs and compression levels can also be set by clicking on **Video** and then on **Compression** before starting the capture. The same can be done with audio. It's best to have the uncompressed videos dumped on your hard disk first and then compressed at a later time.



## Extracting Audio

Some videos have some great music playing; say you want to be able to save the music as an audio track. You can do this, too, in VirtualDub. Open the video file; click on the **Audio** menu and set it to **Full Processing** mode. Select **File > Save WAV** to save the file. Codec settings can then be set by selecting **Audio > Compression** if needed, or else, save the uncompressed WAV file and encode to MP3 (for example) using another program such as Winamp Pro or Foobar. ■